



ADOLESCENCE

The change from being a child to an adult, which happens during the teenage years, is called adolescence. It includes puberty, a period of rapid growth as the body changes shape and the reproductive system develops. During this stage, behavior alters as teenagers learn to live with less help from their parents and do things for themselves.

CHANGES DURING PUBERTY

Puberty is a time when rapid change sets in, between the ages of 10 and 12 in girls, and 12 and 14 in boys. Both girls and boys show a "growth spurt" as their bodies mature and their reproductive systems start working. By the age of 14 or 15, the average boy is taller, heavier, and stronger than the average girl.



► **TEENAGE YEARS** *Surging hormones make boys' voices deepen and facial hair appear, so they have to start shaving.*

OLD AGE

As you grow older, your body takes longer to repair itself and replace worn-out cells. This causes aging, the signs of which are more obvious over the age of 60. Hair thins and turns gray, the skin wrinkles, and sight and hearing become less efficient. Muscles become weaker, joints stiffer and less mobile, and bones may become brittle and more likely to break. However, a good diet and regular exercise during adulthood can reduce the effects of aging.

ADULTHOOD

Between the ages of 18 and 20, the body stops growing. This is the beginning of adulthood. In early adulthood, we reach the peak of fitness and fertility (the ability to have children). Adulthood is also a time of great responsibility when we focus on work and family.

